

一

人

大

上

Person

KANJI

LV 1

ON じん、にん

KUN ひと

MNEMONIC This kanji looks just like a Person walking, striding forward on two legs.

READING A じん (jin) is what you call a person from somewhere — an American person is an American-jin.

人 ひと Person

あの人は誰ですか。

Who is that person?

One

KANJI

LV 1

ON いち、いつ

KUN ひと

MNEMONIC Lying on the ground is something that looks just like the ground, the number One. Why is this One lying down? It's been shot by the number two.

READING One reason this kanji is read いち (ichi): picture someone with just one itch they can't stop scratching.

一 いち One

一から始めましょう。

Let's start from the beginning.

Above · Up

KANJI

LV 1

ON じょう

KUN うえ、あ

MNEMONIC A short line sitting Above the long ground line. Whatever sits on top is above.

READING Read じょう (jou): picture your friend Joe standing up above you on the roof.

上 うえ Above

机の上に本があります。

There is a book on the desk.

Big · Large

KANJI

LV 1

ON たい、だい

KUN おお

MNEMONIC A Person spreading their arms out as wide as possible to show you how Big something is.

READING When something is really だい (dai) big, imagine it is so huge it could cause you to die.

大きい おおきい Big

大きい犬ですね。

That's a big dog, isn't it?

山

口

Mouth

KANJI

LV 1

ON こう、く

KUN ouchi

MNEMONIC A big open square is your wide-open Mouth, ready for the dentist.

READING Read こう (kou): open your mouth and out comes a loud cow-like 'kou' sound.

口 ouchi Mouth

口を大きく開けてください。

Please open your mouth wide.

Mountain

KANJI

LV 1

ON さん

KUN yama

MNEMONIC Three peaks rising up next to each other — that's a Mountain range.

READING Read さん (san): the mountain is so grand you politely call it Mountain-san.

山 yama Mountain

山に登ります。

I climb the mountain.